



Travel Monkey

YOUR HOUSEHOLD'S TRAVEL CONCIERGE

User guide

A companion for better days away.

FIELD GUIDE / OCTOBER 2026

Travel Monkey is an iPhone travel concierge. It combines your travelers' preferences, your itinerary and reservations, your meal and activity log, and the phone's location and clock to help you decide where to eat, what to do, and when to leave.

This guide describes the current app. Screenshots use demonstration or test data, including fictional travelers and booking codes. Some show an individual part of a screen. Dates, weather, travel times, and places in the pictures are examples, not current travel advice.

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In this guide

Find a feature, follow the steps, and return whenever you need a hand.

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Before you begin

You need an iPhone running iOS 17 or later and an installed copy of Travel Monkey. The current version is installed by the developer from Xcode. It has no Travel Monkey account or sign-in screen.

To use the concierge, you also need:

- A network connection.
- Your own Anthropic API key, with API usage enabled on its account.
- Location permission for recommendations and travel estimates from where you are.
- Notification permission if you want reminders.

Create a key through the [Claude Console](#). Anthropic's [API key instructions](#) explain the current steps. API usage is billed separately from a Claude chat subscription; see [Anthropic's explanation](#).

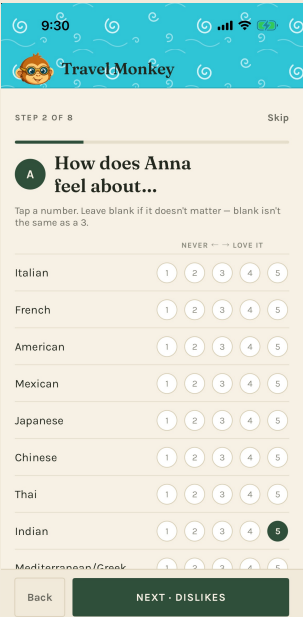
A current limitation: your own initial trip must be prepared and imported with the developer's help in a developer-installed build. Add from text adds bookings to a trip that already exists; it does not create your first trip. You can still ask the concierge questions without a trip, or try [sample data](#).

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Set up your household

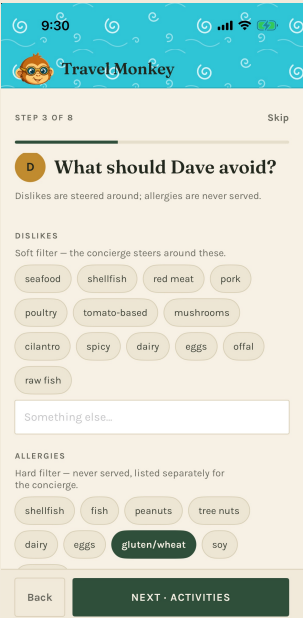
First launch walks you through eight steps. You can skip optional details and return to them in Profile.

1. Who's traveling? Add the household's travelers and optional age bands.
2. Cuisines. Rate each traveler's preferences from 1 to 5. Leave a rating blank if you have no preference to record: blank is different from a neutral 3.
3. Dislikes and allergies. Enter them separately for each traveler. Dislikes are preferences to steer around; allergies are treated as hard exclusions. Use Something else for an allergy that has no chip.
4. Activities. Rate interests such as architecture, hiking, museums, food tours, and live music. Set the household's maximum museums per day.
5. Travel logistics. Enter home airports, loyalty programs, card perks, preferred transport, budget posture, lodging style, and maximum continuous walking time.
6. Permissions. Allow location while using the app and notifications if you want nearby suggestions and reminders. You can change either later.
7. API key. Paste your Anthropic API key. The app checks it before saving it to the iOS Keychain. You can skip this step and add it in Profile → Settings.
8. Done. Tap Ask me where to eat to open the Concierge tab.



IN THE APP

Tap only the ratings you want to record; scroll for the remaining cuisines.



IN THE APP

An allergy belongs in the Allergies section, including when you enter it as free text.

You can revisit the whole flow with Profile → Re-run onboarding, which starts with your existing household details. Guests have their own separate setup under [Travel companions](#).

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Find your way around

The bottom bar has four tabs:

Tab	Use it for
Concierge	Questions, recommendations, the next deadline, current weather, energy, and conversations
Daily	Today's map, timeline, lodging, and weather; arrows let you browse other days
Trip	The complete day list, who's coming, reservations, and adding bookings
Profile	Travelers, guests, household logistics, meal and activity log, rules, and settings

Settings and the Meal & activity log are inside Profile.

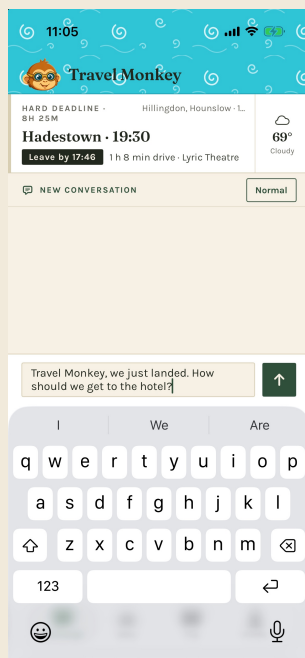
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Ask the concierge

Open Concierge, type in Ask anything..., and tap the upward arrow to send. You do not normally need to retype your preferences, location, or today's itinerary. The app supplies the context it has with each request.

Try questions such as:

- “Where should we eat near the hotel?”
- “What can we do before tonight's show?”
- “Plan tomorrow around our train.”
- “We're tired. Give us something close and easy.”
- “What is still unverified for our departure?”



IN THE APP

The deadline stays above the conversation. Type your question below; the arrow sends it.

The suggestion chips above the composer are shortcuts. Swipe sideways to see more. After some recommendations, they change to refinements such as Somewhere quieter. Tapping a question or refinement sends it immediately. The chips hide while the keyboard is open.

Replies arrive progressively. The turning monkey mark and messages such as Finding places nearby... or Checking travel times... indicate work in progress. Lookups can take longer than a simple answer. Wait until the reply finishes to use its recommendation controls.

Conversations

Tap the conversation label above the transcript to open its menu. Choose New conversation to start fresh, or select an earlier conversation to read it and continue. Conversations belong to the trip and are labeled with the opening question. Starting a new one keeps the old one.

What to expect

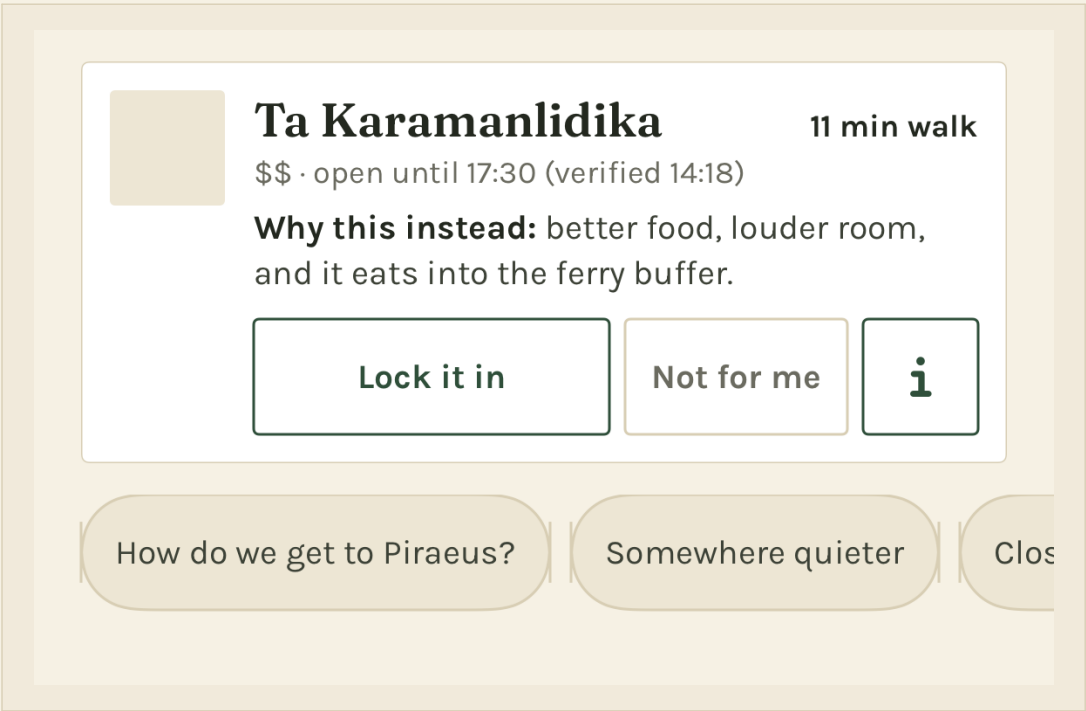
The concierge explains why a suggestion fits and what its tradeoffs are. It may say that a fact is unverified or ask for missing information. Tell it when something is wrong, and ask it to check current details when needed.

It responds when you ask; it does not watch flights, opening hours, or weather and come back later on its own. A promised or suggested check is not a scheduled reminder. For a reminder, ask for an alarm and check that the reply confirms it was set. Travel Monkey does not make bookings or purchases.

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Choose a recommendation

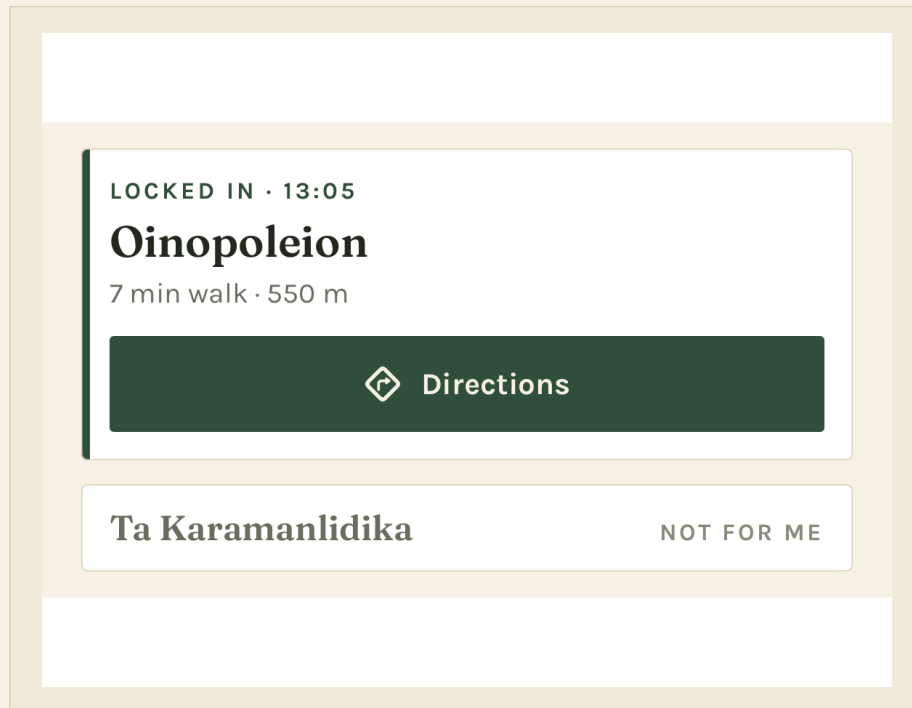
A place recommendation appears as a card. The lead option is larger; alternatives may be compact. Cards can include a map, a street-level photo where available, estimated travel times, a price band, an opening-hours note, a reason, and a tradeoff.



A compact card has the same choice controls as the lead card. This example shows the image placeholder rather than loaded map imagery.

Control	What it does
Lock it in	Records your choice in the conversation and, with an active trip, adds it to today's itinerary
Not for me	Declines the option and lets you give an optional reason
i	Expands more reasoning in place, when the recommendation has extra detail
Directions	Appears after locking in; opens the chosen destination in Maps
Log it	Appears on an unlogged locked plan once its recorded time has passed

With an active trip, locking in records an estimated arrival time based on the current time and travel estimate, rounded up to the next five minutes. It is a choice for now, not a restaurant reservation. For a future booking, use Trip → Add from text. Without an active trip, lock-in records the decision in chat but creates no trip item or meal reminder.



Once chosen, the card collapses to your plan and its Directions control.

Check any verification time shown beside opening hours. It describes the information used for that answer; it is not a live status feed. Also considered, when shown, explains an alternative the concierge weighed and did not choose.

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Set your energy and who is out

Tap the energy pill on the right of the conversation bar. It initially says Normal. The sheet offers:

State	What to ask for
Normal	Full days and the usual range of activities
Low-key today	Shorter walks, sitting down, and lower-effort options
Rest day	Food and hard deadlines, with no additional activity planning

Under Who's out right now, tap travelers to include or exclude them from this outing. Someone excluded is shown as resting. At least one traveler stays selected. The next request uses this selection for group recommendations.

This is different from Trip → Who's coming, which records the whole trip's roster. Today's energy and outing selection reset at the start of a new trip day. A saved rest day is read when the Concierge next checks that day.

After repeated declines of higher-effort suggestions, the app may offer Switch to Low-key today? Choose Yes or Not now. It does not change the setting without your tap.

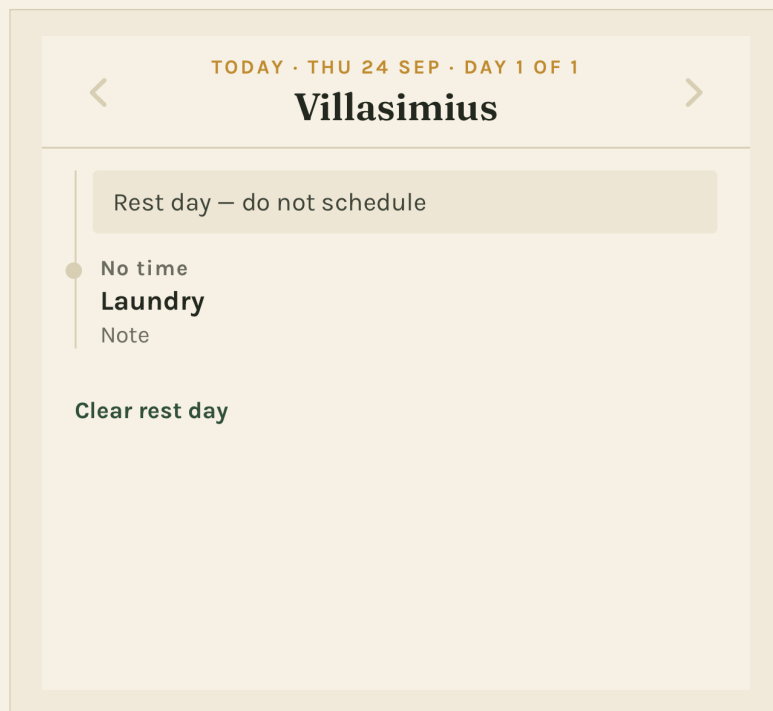
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Read your daily plan

Open Daily for today. Before the trip it opens on the first day; after the trip, on the last. Use the left and right arrows to move between days.

A day can show its map, hourly forecast, hard-deadline callouts, timed items, work hours, untimed notes, and tonight's lodging. Hard deadlines sit above the timeline. Untimed items appear after timed ones. Times are shown in the zone where the event happens; a city is named when needed to distinguish zones.

At the bottom, tap Mark rest day to record a lighter day, or Clear rest day to remove that mark. Marking a rest day does not delete bookings or move deadlines. If you clear the mark after Concierge has switched to Rest day, change the energy pill back yourself.



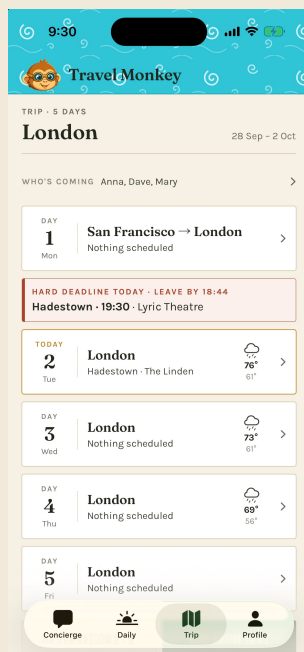
A rest day still shows your recorded plans and notes.

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Manage your trip and reservations

Browse the trip

Open Trip for the complete day list. Today is highlighted. Tap a day to open its map and timeline. A hard deadline appears in a separate callout above that day's row, with a leave-by time when one can be calculated.



IN THE APP

The trip's roster is at the top; a deadline gets its own callout above the day.

Try a sample trip

Open Profile → Settings → Load sample data. The bundled sample is shifted to dates near today and becomes the active trip. You can explore Trip and Daily and ask the concierge about it.

The sample does not move your phone's location. At home, ask explicitly about the sample city or hotel. Nearby suggestions otherwise use your actual location. Sample plans can schedule real local reminders on your phone.

Reload sample data moves its dates near today again and keeps its conversations and logs. Remove sample data asks for confirmation, then deletes the sample trip and its conversations and logs. Your own trips remain; the app selects the appropriate current or upcoming trip again.

If loading reports missing seed data, ask the developer for a build that includes the sample. Do not treat the sample's reservations as your own bookings.

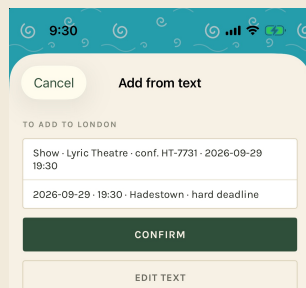
Get your own initial trip into the app

The current developer-installed build imports prepared trip documents. Arrange this with the developer first. When the files are included, use Import trip data from the no-trip screen, or Profile → Settings → Developer → Import from markdown. Review the preview before confirming, especially dates, travelers, allergies, and hard deadlines. Cancel leaves the existing records untouched.

This import control is available only in developer builds. A regular release build currently has no self-service way to create your own initial trip. Pasting a booking into Add from text requires an existing trip.

Add a booking or note to an existing trip

1. Open Trip → Add from text.
2. Paste the confirmation email, booking details, or notes.
3. Tap Read it. This sends the text to the concierge and requires a network and a working API key.
4. Review everything it proposes: day, time, place, confirmation code, and whether the item is a hard deadline.
5. Tap Confirm to save, Edit text to revise the input, or Cancel to leave.



IN THE APP

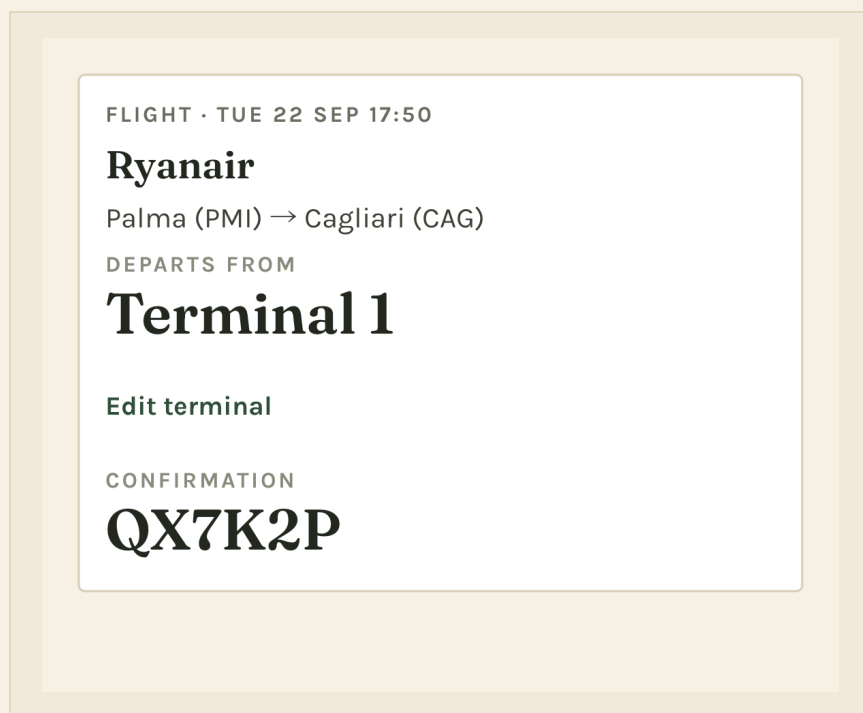
Reading the text produces a proposal. It is saved only after Confirm.

Use Add manually if you want to enter an item yourself, if parsing fails, or if you are offline. Choose a title, kind, day, optional time, and place. Mark Hard deadline - can't be missed when appropriate. The form also has an optional confirmation code, an International flight switch for flights, and Border check before boarding, like the Eurostar for trains. Those distinctions affect arrival buffers.

A lodging booking can fill tonight's lodging across its stay. Pasted items on new dates can add days to an existing trip. Check Daily after saving to make sure the plan reads as intended. The current app has no general editor for every stored booking field; check parsed details before Confirm.

Read reservations and store a departure terminal

From Trip, open Reservations. Use the kind filters to narrow the list. Cards show dates, routes, large confirmation codes, and seats where recorded. Expand Original text when present to reread the source. Codes can be selected and copied.



The departure terminal and confirmation code are easy to read at the airport.

On a flight, tap Add departure terminal or Edit terminal, enter the value, and save. Saving an empty value clears it. A stored terminal also appears with the flight in Daily, deadline callouts, and reminders.

You can also ask the concierge to look up a missing terminal. If it offers to save one, review the source and tap Save or Not now. It needs your tap to store the change. Terminals are stored information; gates and travel status are not monitored live.

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Use maps and directions

Day maps show located items and lodging, with legs between consecutive timed places. Long intercity legs may be dashed straight lines. The map is an overview; navigation opens in a separate Maps app.

On a locked recommendation, tap Directions for Apple Maps. Long-press it to choose Google Maps if installed. The destination and travel mode are passed to that app.

On recommendation maps, green marks the destination and brass marks the location used for the estimate. When the estimate is from lodging, the origin is shown as a house. Without a usable location, distances may be from lodging; check the label.

A no map badge means the item saved but its place could not be located. It does not mean the booking is missing. For an itinerary item, use Find map pin if it has no pin, or Fix map pin if the saved pin is wrong, and review the confirmation before retrying the lookup.

● **17:50**
FR1561 PMI → CAG
Flight · Palma (PMI) · Terminal 1
conf. QX7K2P

Fix map pin

Repair the selected place from its item in Daily or a Trip day.

A repair affects other items and reservations using that same place. It can change travel estimates and leave-by times. If the lookup still fails, the item stays readable without a map pin.

Check the weather

Weather appears in three places when a forecast is available:

- Concierge: current conditions beside the next deadline.
- Trip: a forecast icon and high/low for each day within the forecast range.
- Daily: hourly conditions and weather beside timed items.

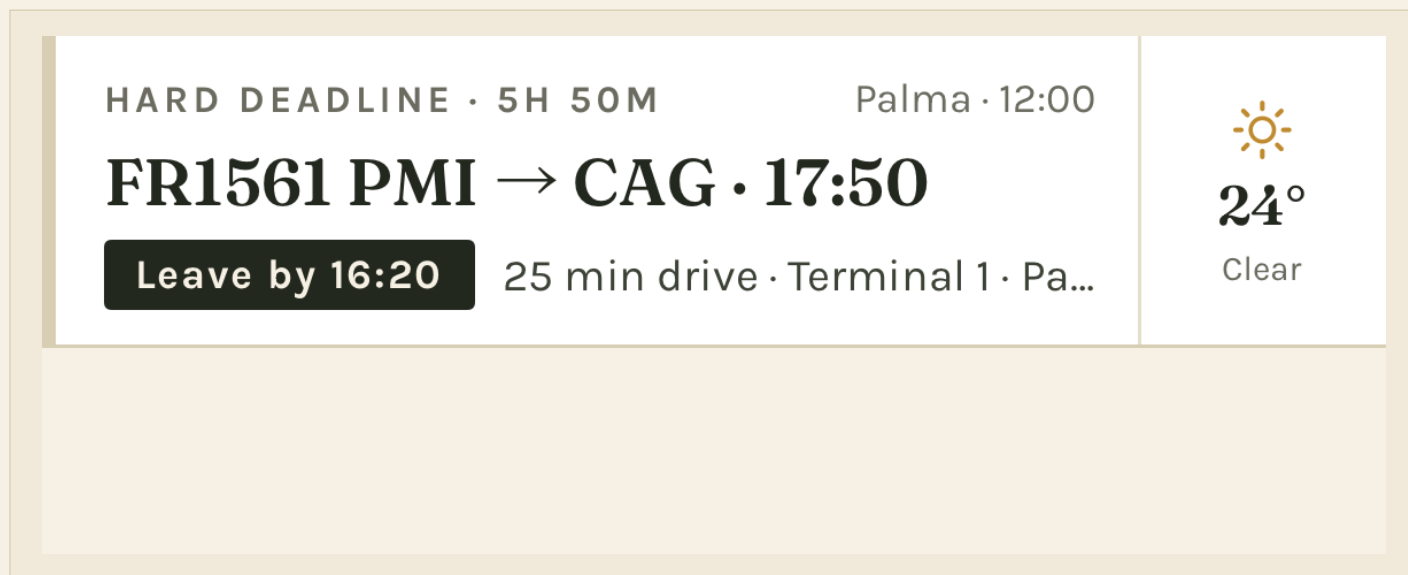
Tap the weather chip on Concierge to open the report: current conditions, the next six hours, sunset, UV, wind, rain chance, and a three-day outlook. It can also include a concierge-written explanation of what the forecast means for today's plan. That explanation uses the API and can incur usage charges.

Tap Ask about it to send “How should today's weather change our plans?” to the concierge, or Done to close the report.

A cached forecast may show its age. With location unavailable, the current-weather chip may be absent while trip-day forecasts still work from itinerary locations. A missing icon can mean no forecast, an unavailable service, or a date too far ahead.

Understand leave-by reminders

The strip at the top of Concierge shows the next hard deadline and its leave-by time. Tap the deadline to find it in Trip. It turns red when the leave-by is within three hours. A flight's terminal appears when stored.



The event time and leave-by time are different: leave-by is when to start moving.

Leave-by allows for estimated travel, a 20-minute transition buffer, and the item's arrival buffer. The current defaults are 45 minutes for domestic flights and ordinary trains, 60 for international flights, 90 for trains with border checks before boarding, and 15 for other items. The app uses your transport preference, switching away from long walks when another mode can be routed.

These are the app's planning allowances. If a booking or carrier requires earlier arrival, use that requirement and ask the concierge for an earlier alarm. ETA unknown means the displayed leave-by lacks a usable travel estimate.

Which reminders you receive

Reminder	Behavior
Departure	Normally one heads-up an hour before leave-by and one at leave-by; past steps are skipped
Connection	A flight or train connection with four hours or less on the ground gets one boarding note instead of the two departure alarms
An alarm you ask for	The concierge can set an alarm for a chosen plan or a time you request; check its confirmation
Still here	Optional warning 15 minutes before leave-by if you have not left the monitored departure area
Log it later	A meal reminder about two hours after a locked-in meal's recorded time; not during 21:30-08:00 local quiet hours
Rest day	An 08:00 nudge on day 4 of a stretch without a rest day, then day 7, 10, and so on

The optional Still here warning requires Profile → Settings → Warn me if I haven't left, plus Always location permission. Ordinary recommendations and travel estimates work with While Using the App.

Expand a notification to see its available actions: Snooze 10 for a leave-by alarm, Open directions for a still-here warning, verdicts for a meal log, or Mark rest day for a rest-day nudge. Marking rest day changes the day flag, not its reservations.

Reminders are local and are scheduled up to seven days ahead. Open the app regularly and after changes to refresh upcoming reminders. An automatic trip deadline can be scheduled as it enters that window; an alarm requested in chat for more than seven days away is not saved for later. Ask again within seven days.

With notifications off, deadline information remains visible but no alarm is set. Overlapping reminders may be combined, and limited notification capacity gives leave-by alarms priority. Reminders do not track delays or schedule changes from a carrier.

Log meals and activities

Record what worked so later suggestions can use it. Open the quick log by:

- Tapping Log it on a locked card once its time has passed.
- Tapping a meal reminder, or expanding it and choosing a verdict directly.
- Tapping a Log [place] suggestion chip when it appears.
- Asking the concierge, for example, “Log lunch: we loved the curry, but the room was too loud.” It opens a draft for you to review and save.

In the quick log, check who was there, choose Loved it, Fine, or Not again, then tap Save to log. You can add a short preference note, a meal's cuisine, and dishes. The note is most useful when it says what to repeat or avoid next time. Later closes a new draft without saving it.

Open Profile → Meal & activity log to browse entries grouped by trip, newest first. Filter by Meals, Activities, or Hotels, then by verdict or traveler. Tap an entry to edit and choose Save changes. The log has no delete control.

Teach the concierge

Keep a correction

If an answer is wrong, say exactly what should change. The concierge can offer Keep this correction? with a proposed line. Tap Save to include it in future conversations and trips, or Not now to leave it out of lasting memory.

Review kept corrections under Profile → Rules → Your corrections. Remove, with confirmation, stops including that line in future requests. The bundled rules below are read-only and show their version.

Consolidate a trip's log

From Profile → Meal & activity log, find the trip and tap Consolidate this trip. On the next screen, tap Consolidate this trip to run the review. It needs entries, a connection, and your API key; you can do it during or after the trip.

The concierge proposes profile changes with their supporting log entries. Review each and choose Accept or Reject. Accepted changes affect subsequent requests. Allergy changes require an additional confirmation. Nothing changes just because the model proposed it.

Recent log entries already help the concierge before consolidation. Consolidation is how you turn those experiences into lasting profile preferences.

Edit profiles and settings

Travelers and guests

Under Profile, tap a traveler to edit cuisines, activities, dislikes, allergies, dietary rules, and notes, then Save. An allergy change asks for confirmation. Add traveler adds a household member. The last household traveler cannot be removed. Removing someone who has logs preserves those entries.

Use Add a companion for a guest joining some trips. Their setup covers name, cuisines, dislikes and allergies, and activities. Then open Trip → Who's coming to include them in that trip's roster. A guest's full profile is used on trips they join. You can also record free-text companions who have no profile, but their names alone do not supply dietary preferences or allergies.

Household logistics

Tap the Logistics card in Profile to change shared transport, budget, lodging, walking limits, airports, loyalty programs, and perks. Changes save as you edit.

Settings

Setting	Use it for
Anthropic API key	Add or replace the key; the app validates it and shows only its last four characters
Provider / Model / Effort	Choose from the available models and effort levels; Model default uses the model's default effort
Leave-by reminders	Enable the optional still-here warning
Permissions	Check location and notification status; Change in iOS Settings opens the phone's settings
iCloud → Sync	See whether your private iCloud account is available
Sample data	Load, reload, or remove the sample trip
Privacy	Read a summary of the information sent with concierge requests
Developer	Import prepared markdown trip data, in developer builds only

Higher effort can take longer and cost more. The model choice applies to questions, imports, and summaries. Use the in-app recommendation as a starting point and review actual usage in your Claude Console; costs vary with conversation length and lookups.

Profile → Reset memory asks you to confirm deletion of every conversation for the active trip. It keeps itinerary, reservations, logs, and saved corrections. Starting a new conversation is the option to use when you want a fresh chat without deleting old ones.

Data, iCloud, and offline use

Profiles, trips, reservations, logs, and conversations are stored on the phone. If iCloud is available, they sync to your own private iCloud account. The current app does not share a household between different Apple Accounts; each person's phone has its own copy unless it uses the same account.

Your API key stays in the iOS Keychain. Concierge questions, pasted-text parsing, consolidation, and the weather report's written explanation send relevant information to Anthropic. Maps and weather use Apple services. Read the [Privacy Policy](#) for the full details.

Offline, you can read saved trip details, reservations, logs, and conversations, and use manual item entry. Concierge questions and pasted-text parsing require a connection. New maps, travel estimates, and forecasts may be unavailable; previously scheduled local notifications can still fire.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
No trip yet	Use sample data, or arrange your initial import with the developer. Add from text cannot create your first trip. Chat works without one.
Sample data will not load	If the error says seed data is missing, the developer needs to provide a build with the sample file.
Missing or invalid API key	Open Profile → Settings and enter a working key. Check its API account, expiration, and billing in the Claude Console.
The concierge is unavailable	Check your connection and the displayed error. If the service is busy, try again later.
The reply is taking time	A question with several searches can take a minute or more. Look for the progress indicator or lookup message.
Recommendations are in the wrong city	Check location permission, who is out, and the active trip. With sample data, name the city explicitly; your phone is still where you are.
Wrong or missing map pin	Use Fix map pin or Find map pin on the item's day, then check its position and leave-by time again.
ETA unknown	A route or usable origin is missing. The time may include buffers without travel; plan the journey yourself or ask the concierge for help.
No current-weather chip	Check location access. Forecasts may also be unavailable or outside their range; absent weather does not remove the trip.
No reminders	Check Notifications in Profile → Settings, open the app to refresh, and verify that the deadline has a time. Check iOS notification and Focus settings.
No still-here warning	Check Warn me if I haven't left and Always location access. Connecting departures do not use that warning.
An alarm was refused	Check notifications and whether it is within seven days. A refused chat alarm does not schedule itself later.
A save error appears	Follow the banner and retry the save before closing the app. Visible edits may not have been persisted.
A companion isn't considered	Add their profile, include them in Trip → Who's coming, and check Who's out right now in the energy sheet.

Problem	What to check
No iCloud sync	Check the Sync row and your Apple Account. The app works locally; different Apple Accounts do not share a household.

For a problem you cannot resolve, follow the [support instructions](#). Use fictional or redacted details in public reports, and never include your API key.